

TABLE 1

Partial Correlations Between Stroop Scores and Nonverbal and Verbal Responses

Response	Chinese experimenter		White experimenter	
	Divided attention	Full attention	Divided attention	Full attention
Nonverbal	-.34 (.22)	.54* (.17)	.12 (.27)	-.20 (.24)
Verbal	-.25 (.23)	.36 (.20)	.12 (.27)	-.34 (.22)

Note. Standard errors are presented in parentheses.

* $p < .05$.

knowing the social rules, but are also dependent on the ability to apply these rules in challenging circumstances.

Perhaps the most striking aspect of these results is that a correlation emerged between two tasks that, at least on the surface, appear to involve control of such different kinds of responses. The fact that successful suppression of word meaning to enable rapid naming of ink colors predicted successful suppression of disgust toward a Chinese-style chicken foot to enable polite interaction with a Chinese experimenter suggests that there is overlap in the inhibition and control required by these two tasks. The literature on cognitive inhibition is plagued by the fact that different measures of inhibition are often uncorrelated (Kramer, Humphrey, Larish, Logan, & Strayer, 1994). There are a number of theories intended to explain these dissociations (e.g., Friedman & Miyake, 2004), but the current results suggest that it may be useful to examine the relationships between measures of cognitive inhibition and problems of social control. If the prefrontal cortex developed in part to enable voluntary control over sexual and aggressive behavior (Bjorklund & Harnishfeger, 1995) or other behaviors that may not serve long-term interests (Boysen, Mukobi, & Berntson, 1999; Kieras et al., 2005; Mischel & Ayduk, 2004), then proper understanding of different measures of cognitive inhibition may be facilitated by examining their role in social functioning.

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